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The field station logged a quiet week, with instruments holding steady across every recorded channel and no alarms tripping after the storm front cleared the ridge on Monday. The crew used the lull to recalibrate the older sensors and to revisit the monitoring cadence that had drifted out of step during the busier stretch earlier in the season.

By the weekend the reservoir had risen a few inches and the access road was passable again, so the supply run went out on schedule and returned with the replacement filters everyone had been waiting on for two weeks.

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Analysis of the spring samples confirmed what the rough field notes had already suggested, namely that the turbidity spikes tracked the rainfall almost exactly and faded within a day once the inflow settled. The lab recommended tightening the monitoring cadence around storm events so the first flush is captured before it dilutes into the broader record.

A second batch, drawn from the lower basin, told a calmer story and gave the team a clean baseline to compare the disturbed upstream readings against when they prepare the mid-year report for the oversight board.

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The equipment budget came in under the projected ceiling, largely because two of the planned replacements were deferred after a closer inspection showed the existing units would last another full season with minor servicing. Those savings were redirected toward a spare data logger and a longer monitoring cadence trial on the north transect.

Training for the incoming seasonal staff is scheduled for the last week of the month, and the handbook has been revised to fold in the lessons from the previous rotation so the new crew starts on firmer footing.

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Looking ahead, the steering group wants the next phase to emphasize consistency over coverage, trimming a few of the redundant sampling sites in favor of a denser record at the locations that actually drive the model. Holding a steady monitoring cadence at those anchor points, they argued, will do more for the long-term trend than scattering effort thinly.

The season will close with a public summary and an open dataset, both of which are already drafted and waiting only on the final quarter of readings before they can be released to the wider community.